

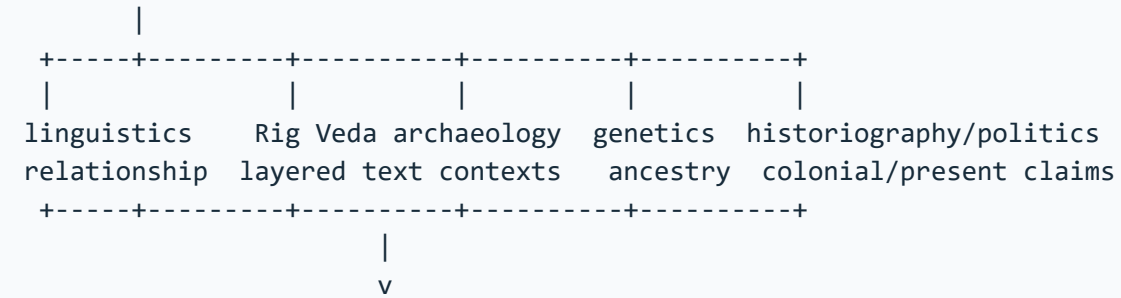
ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Category firewall: language is not race

TERM	VALID USE	INVALID COLLAPSE
arya	self/cultural designation	biological race
Indo-Aryan	branch of Indo-Iranian languages	skull type or pure people
Indo-Iranian	linguistic-cultural relationship	one archaeological culture
Aryan culture	reconstructed practices/texts	uniform invading nation
	v	

Separate language, ancestry, material culture and identity before comparison.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Why the Aryan problem persists

QUESTION: how did Indo-Aryan speech and early Vedic culture form in South Asia?

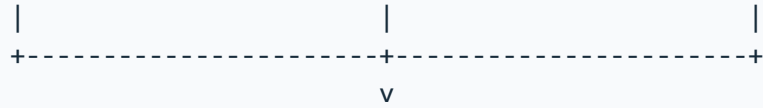


No class alone identifies a group, route, date and cultural outcome.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Working chronology and interaction corridor

SINTASHTA/STEPPE -> CENTRAL ASIAN/BMAC CONTACT -> NORTH-WEST SOUTH ASIA -> VEDIC MILIEU

2nd millennium BCE technology/speech hypotheses -> interaction -> cultural synthesis



Mitanni Indo-Aryan names and terms provide external attestation in western Asia.

A corridor model is not a mapped army route; scale and social process stay open.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Linguistic evidence: descent plus contact

regular sound correspondences + shared vocabulary + grammar

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v

Indo-European family -> Indo-Iranian branch -> Indo-Aryan differentiation

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inherited vocabulary

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loanwords and retroflexion from contact

+-----+-----+

v

Language transmission cannot alone specify genes, route or invasion.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Rigvedic identity: a cultural system

RIG VEDA: layered oral corpus in a north-western Sapta-Sindhu milieu

- |-- economy: cattle-centred pastoralism with agriculture and crafts
- |-- polity: jana, vis, rajan, sabha, samiti; no territorial empire
- |-- society: kinship/difference; later caste must not be projected backward
- |-- religion: deities, rita, yajna, soma and praise-poetry
- |-- warfare: horse/chariot terms and cattle/route conflicts

+> identity is cultural-historical, not a racial phenotype.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Archaeological cultures are not peoples

Cemetery H	Gandhara Grave/Swat	OCP/Copper Hoards	PGW
Punjab mortuary	frontier burials and	upper Ganga material	later plain horizon
change/continuity	interaction	associations vary	settlement pattern
+-----+-----+-----+			
v			

None equals Aryan people by itself; relate dates, regions and practices cautiously.
Sanauli vehicles cannot settle horse-chariot identity without technical context.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Archaeogenetics: result and claim boundary

ANCIENT SAMPLE -> contamination control -> genetic components -> statistical model

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v

Rakhigarhi: one Harappan-context genome; not the whole civilisation.

South/Central Asian aDNA models: later Steppe-related ancestry entered South Asia.

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v

Ancestry can show mixture/timing ranges, not language or self-identity alone.

Sampling is sparse, uneven and vulnerable to political overclaim.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Competing models and best-fit verdict

INVASION: rapid violent replacement -> simplistic and archaeologically weak

IN-MIGRATION: movement over time + interaction -> better multi-source fit

INDIGENOUS/OIT: local formation/outward movement -> must explain linguistic geography,
Mitanni evidence and ancient-DNA patterns

SYNTHESIS: mobility + continuity + borrowing + intermarriage + cultural recomposition

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v

VERDICT: migration is not conquest; continuity is not isolation; evidence is graded.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Aryan-problem answer architecture

10 MARKS: define categories -> two evidence classes -> one limit -> cautious verdict

15 MARKS: historiography -> linguistic case -> text/archaeology -> genetics -> synthesis

20 MARKS: firewall -> evidence matrix -> corridor -> competing models

-> Harappan continuity/contact -> political misuse -> graded conclusion

EVIDENCE VERB: supports / is consistent with / complicates; avoid proves when indirect.

CLOSE: early Vedic culture formed through mobility and South Asian interaction, not race.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Evidence ladder and confidence control

EVIDENCE LADDER

1. = from source book = inference / standard knowledge = current affairs.
2. RS Sharma stresses there is no evidence of mass-scale confrontation...
3. Evidence type What it suggests UPSC caution

VERDICT: Source type controls the strength and limits of the historical claim.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Examiner traps and contested boundaries

CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

1. Evidence discipline: no current-affairs claim is forced into this...
2. Contested issues Competing interpretations are attributed, evidenced...
3. Inscription and coin evidence: contemporary names, titles, claims and...

VERDICT: Qualification earns marks; false certainty is a hard failure.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Integrated answer spine and qualified conclusion

ANSWER SPINE

1. Required scope: Keep text, language, archaeology and genetics...
2. Basic completeness: substantive owner material is retained in a...
3. Original solved 10-mark Mains 2

VERDICT: Claim, named evidence, analysis and qualification lead to a graded...